IJPE alignment and author check record

Prepared 3 November 2026. This record accompanies the journal revision; it is not part of the research article.

Source verification

The official IJPE journal page identifies pavement evaluation and management within its scope and states triple-anonymised peer review. It also lists an optional Open Select route. The current complete Instructions for Authors endpoints returned HTTP 403 during this check; browser access was also unavailable. Consequently, the revision distinguishes verified publisher guidance from journal-specific items requiring a final check.

Item	Basis and action	Status
Scope and review	Pavement-screening interpretation; separate title page and anonymous main/supplement PDFs	Official journal page verified
Typography and layout	Times New Roman 12 pt, double-spaced text, A4, 25-mm margins, numbered headings and review line numbers	Publisher general layout guidance
Abstract and keywords	One unstructured abstract and five keywords	Conservative preparation choice; current journal limits unverified
References	Consistent author–date citations; alphabetical references; DOI links	Matches published IJPE examples; current mandatory style unverified
Tables and figures	Editable tables and vector figures supplied separately; historical numerical table values retained, with new independent-source and event tables	Locally verified; exact current upload rules unverified
Declarations	Supplied contributions, no funding and no competing interests; factual secondary-data statement and AI-use disclosure	Supplied/known facts incorporated

Editorial changes

The title, introduction and discussion now centre on classification-based pavement screening and evaluation across acquisition conditions. The article separates screening labels from roughness, severity and structural-condition measurements. Repeated disclaimers, internal simulated-review history and implementation diary passages were removed or condensed. One non-data contribution/claim matrix is retained only in the editorial archive. Five core tables appear in the article; six former main-text control tables now appear in Supplementary Section S15. Historical numerical values and contrary results are retained. The independent Karlsruhe date holdout and labelled-event diagnostics are reported with their source, grouping and exposure denominators.

The PVS primary criterion, disjoint-window increases in estimation MAE, common-budget diagnostic and identical Mexico selections remain explicit. Definitions and acquisition counts are given where needed for interpretation, with the evidence scope discussed once. The framework architecture remains an optional standalone vector asset; it is not assumed to be a required graphical abstract.

Submission files

- `main_anonymous.pdf`: manuscript for anonymous review, with references, tables and figures.
- `supplementary_anonymous.pdf`: anonymous supplementary methods and results.
- `title_page.pdf`: author identities and correspondence; assign the submission system's non-review role.
- `cover_letter.pdf`: cover-letter draft for the editor.
- `main.pdf` and `supplementary.pdf`: author-inclusive reading versions.
- Editable TeX, vector figures, table files, source code and a separate anonymised-source archive accompany the PDFs.

Items for the authors before submission

1. Confirm whether the institution requires ethics review or an exemption determination for secondary road-sensor data that include GPS and coded driver groups. No approval or exemption has been asserted. The manuscript states the actual data-use design.
2. Review the final article, analysis evidence, references and AI-assisted material. All authors' approval of the final version, submission and authorship accountability must be confirmed by the authors. The supplied contribution roles are used without adding supervision or other unreported roles.
3. Check the correspondence address, each author's email and any ORCID fields requested by the live submission system. Only the supplied correspondence email is currently recorded.
4. Open the live IJPE Instructions for Authors and confirm the current word/abstract limits, reference style, accepted LaTeX/source package, file roles, artwork rules and any journal-specific AI restrictions. Publisher-wide guidance does not establish these journal-specific requirements.
5. Check the declaration of AI assistance against the actual tool/model history. This revision records drafting, coding, figure-code and language assistance, rather than describing the use as proofreading alone.

The existing public repository contains earlier author-identifying material. Direct identity fields and repository links are removed from the anonymous review files, but pre-existing public availability remains searchable. No submission, editor contact or publication action has been performed as part of this revision.

Official sources consulted

1. IJPE scope/review: `https://www.tandfonline.com/journals/gpav20`.
2. Current IFA endpoint (HTTP 403): `https://www.tandfonline.com/action/authorSubmission?show=instructions&journalCode=gpav20`.
3. Publisher layout guide: `https://authorservices.taylorandfrancis.com/publishing-your-research/writing-your-paper/journal-manuscript-layout-guide/`.

4. Publisher templates guidance: https://authorservices.taylorandfrancis.com/publishing-your-research/writing-your-paper/formatting-and-templates/.
5. AI policy: https://taylorandfrancis.com/our-policies/ai-policy/.
6. Secondary-data and research-ethics policy: https://authorservices.taylorandfrancis.com/editorial-policies/research-ethics-guidelines-for-stem-journals/.
7. IJPE evaluation example and citation style: https://doi.org/10.1080/10298436.2023.2183402.